

Varginha

alien body recovery case which had been mentioned before we went down.

The press coverage of the case had been very extensive, including a Brazilian UFO Newsletter (in English), a 6 Page cover story in a weekly news magazine, and on major TV programs. Vitorrio Pacaccini who spoke excellent English, had been investigating the case since January.

He was able to talk to many different witnesses including the three girls who spotted one of the small brown skinned, big headed, big red eyed, dazed creatures, in January, 1996.

He is from nearby, and, because he owns three coffee plantations, was able to take the time to track down many military and medical and local witnesses.

He gave a dual presentation with a lawyer with whom he worked very closely. He was gracious enough to spend well over an hour being privately interviewed by John Carpenter (MUFON's Abductions Coordinator), Graham Birdsall (Editor of the UK UFO Magazine, circulation over 100,000) and myself on video tape. Also one of the local people translated much of their joint presentation.

We heard of wreckage as well as bodies, sightings of low level submarine shaped flying craft which disturbed a nearby farmer's animals a few hours earlier, and also that a (military) truck load of strange wreckage was observed. We also were told of an apparent notification by the US government to the Brazilian military that something was coming down from the sky in that area.

Dr. John Mack of Harvard had been to Brazil before we arrived and had interrogated the three female witnesses. He concluded that they had been traumatized and had been telling the truth. We heard of (but did not hear) a 42 minute tape of a military man telling what happened. It seems clear that several bodies were recovered, some dead some alive. I had been wary of the notion that the fire department would go out with nets, but found that it responds to reports of wild animals that way. Whether they were crew or cargo is not known.

Some people were comparing the case to Roswell. There were indeed many civilian, military and professional people involved. However, there is very little in the way of testimony from the high ranking officers or medical people, comparable to Retired USAF General DuBose or Major Marcel, or his son Dr. Marcel.

A.J. Gevaerd, MUFON Representative in Brazil and editor of one of the largest Brazilian UFO Publications was a gracious host, and gave a very well received paper about Varginha at the July MUFON Symposium. (I am

offering a 2 page article about this case to anyone sending a self addressed, stamped, no. 10 business envelope to me at POB 958, Houlton, ME 04730-0958.)

Unfortunately the Wall Street Journal carried a large, front page story, misquoting me, and taking a disdainful tone.

Independence Day

New admission records were set by this alien invader flag waving movie. TIME and NEWSWEEK had cover stories the same week. The focus was on science fiction with reference to UFOS, but not the slightest indication of the vast array of solid data that is available.

Obviously the media are more comfortable focusing on entertainment rather than facts and data relevant to the reality of Roswell and the Cosmic Watergate.

Books

I read UK Ministry of Defense UFO Investigator Nick Pope's book "Open Skies, Closed Minds" with great expectations, but finished with great disappointment. The book is very superficial, frequently factually inaccurate, poorly referenced and also resorts to poor reasoning from time to time. I will be preparing a detailed review.

Travis Walton's book "Fire in the Sky: The Travis Walton Experience" (Marlowe and Co.) is a much better read. Excellent insight is provided about

why movie makers do what they do and how little creative control the subject of a basically biographical movie has on the script. For anyone who still thinks debunker Philip Klass's explanations of the experience as a hoax promulgated to protect Mike Roger's logging activities, is a good one, Walton's detailed review of Klass' nefarious activities is well worth the price of the book.

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